

Funder and trustee reporting checklist

Twelve checks before your figures leave the building. Tick the ones that are true for your next report.

Before you start

- ☐ **1. One purpose, one deadline.** You know which report this is, who reads it, what decision it supports, the period it covers and when it's due.
- ☐ **2. One owner.** A named person assembles it, and you know who supplies each part, who checks it, who signs it off, and who covers if they're away.
- ☐ **3. A list of sources.** Each spreadsheet or system the figures come from is written down, with who keeps it and the cut-off date.

Counting the same way every time

- ☐ **4. Definitions written down.** What counts as a participant, a session, an attendance and an outcome is written in one place.
- ☐ **5. People and attendances kept apart.** You report unique people separately from total attendances, and say which one each funder asked for.
- ☐ **6. The same definitions for every funder.** Where a funder needs something different, you work it out from the same records and note the difference.

Checking before sign-off

- ☐ **7. Totals add back.** Every headline figure can be traced back to the activity records it came from.
- ☐ **8. Compared with last time.** Big changes since the last report are explained, not quietly adjusted.
- ☐ **9. Duplicates and gaps checked.** You've looked for people counted twice, missing months or sites, and late returns.
- ☐ **10. Problems listed, not hidden.** Anything missing, doubtful or estimated is on a short list that the person signing off can see.

Making next time easier

- ☐ **11. A short how-to.** The steps, file locations and deadlines are written down so someone else could produce the report.
- ☐ **12. Evidence kept for bids.** Volunteer hours, feedback and outcomes are recorded in a way you could use in your next application.

How did you score?

10–12: a solid process. Your figures will stand up to questions.

6–9: workable, but it relies on people remembering things. Start with the gaps in the first two sections.

0–5: fragile. One absence or a new funder could cause real problems. Fix definitions and ownership first.

Three questions for your next team meeting

1. Which step causes the most last-minute chasing or copying?
2. Which figure would be hardest for someone else to reproduce next month?
3. What should trustees see as a known issue rather than discover as a surprise?

This checklist is a practical guide, not accounting, audit or legal advice. You don't need to share any personal data to use it. If you'd like help, the £295 Reporting & Insight Review looks at one of your reports in detail: zktheory.org/services.